



Reading: Introduction to Stakeholder Management

Estimated time: 2 minutes

Introduction

In this reading, you will learn about the core principles of stakeholder management by learning how to identify, engage, and manage stakeholders effectively throughout the project lifecycle. You will also explore how to apply key stakeholder management tools, including the RACI Matrix, Stakeholder Register, and Stakeholder Engagement Plan, to enhance communication, clarify responsibilities, and ensure project alignment.

Every project or initiative succeeds or struggles because of the people involved. Stakeholders include anyone impacted by the project, from executives and customers to team members and support staff. Understanding how to identify, engage, and manage these individuals is essential for project success.

Stakeholder management approaches

Stakeholder management focuses on a three-step approach, which includes the following three steps:

1. **Identify stakeholders:** Think of who needs to be considered. This step ensures you know everyone with influence, interest, or impact on the project.
2. **Engage stakeholders:** Consider how you communicate and involve them effectively. Engagement is about building trust and securing the right level of participation.
3. **Manage stakeholders throughout the project:** This includes how you adapt as needs and priorities change. Stakeholder management is not a one-time activity; it requires continuous monitoring and adjustment.

To support this approach, you will learn about three practical tools that can be applied by project managers, business analysts, and organizational leaders alike:

- **RACI matrix (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed):** A simple framework for clarifying roles and responsibilities, preventing confusion, and ensuring accountability.
- **Stakeholder register:** A structured list that captures who stakeholders are, their interests, level of influence, and how they should be engaged. This becomes a living document throughout the project.
- **Stakeholder engagement plan:** A roadmap that defines communication strategies, engagement methods, and actions needed to maintain alignment and support.

These tools are versatile. Whether you're leading a formal project, working as a business analyst, or managing a department, they help ensure people are heard, responsibilities are clear, and expectations are managed.

By mastering these essentials, you'll gain the confidence to navigate complex relationships, minimize conflict, and increase the likelihood of achieving both project goals and organizational value.

Summary

In this reading, you learned that stakeholder management is critical to project success, as it focuses on the people who influence or are impacted by the project.

- The three-step approach—identify, engage, and manage stakeholders—helps ensure inclusion, trust, and adaptability.
- The RACI matrix clarifies who is responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed, promoting accountability and preventing role confusion.
- The stakeholder register serves as a living document to track stakeholder details, interests, and influence levels.
- The stakeholder engagement plan outlines communication and engagement strategies to maintain alignment and support throughout the project.

© SkillUp

Materials may not be reproduced in whole or in part without written permission from SkillUp.